those decisions even if taken under pressure from the 1 Akbar Road group.

This was not the first or the last time that religious and sectarian divides in Indian society was or would be exploited by the ruling or opposition parties for political gains. Such exploitation will continue as long as the country does not have a well-informed and politically evolved electorate, capable of seeing through such games and electing their representatives based purely on their past performance and/or future potential to look after their interests. However, this was the only time that senior leaders of the ruling party, soon after winning an election, started planning their party's victory at the next elections five years away, by first creating and then resolving a religious divide of gigantic proportions. That too, one between Hindus and Sikhs, where there is a very thin, in some cases even blurred, line dividing the two communities.

One can only wish and pray that such a thing never happens again in a secular and democratic India, which prides itself in the values enshrined in the Vedic Sanskrit phrase V*asudhaiva Kutumbakam* , which views the entire earth as family. This phrase is also engraved in the entrance hall of the Indian parliament. It appears that the architects of Op-2 were either totally oblivious of their Vedic heritage or could not care less about such values.